ROALLA



EXECUTIVE TECHNOLOGY DUE DILIGENCE GUIDE

Technology Due Diligence Guide 2026

A decision framework for investors, acquirers and growth-stage technology companies

Prepared for Investors, acquirers, boards, founders, chief executives and technology leaders

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

Status date: 6 October 2026

Purpose

This guide helps decision-makers test whether a technology business can support the investment thesis, growth plan or integration case. It evaluates product architecture, technical debt, security, intellectual property, team dependency, scalability, data, delivery capability and operational resilience using evidence tied to commercial consequences.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Technology diligence should explain how technical realities affect value, risk, growth capacity, integration effort and post-transaction investment. A polished product demonstration is not a substitute for architecture, security, ownership, operating and delivery evidence.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Does technology support the thesis?	**CONDITIONAL**	Connect product evidence, architecture and delivery capability to growth assumptions.
Are there transaction-critical issues?	**DECIDE**	Identify security, IP, continuity, compliance and concentration risks immediately.
Can the platform scale economically?	**PREPARE**	Validate capacity, reliability, cloud cost, data and operational dependencies.
Can the team execute post-transaction?	**CONDITIONAL**	Assess leadership, key-person dependency, delivery health and integration load.
What should management authorize?	**PURSUE**	A staged diligence review with an evidence request and red-flag escalation process.

Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Technology Diligence Gates

Diligence converts technical observations into transaction and operating decisions. Findings should be evidence-based, material to the thesis and expressed with remediation cost, timing, dependency and management implications.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Product	Roadmap and customer value support the thesis	Adoption, retention, roadmap and differentiation
02	Architecture	The platform can scale and evolve	System design, constraints and transition needs
03	Code	Quality and delivery practices are sustainable	Repositories, testing, release and defect evidence
04	Security	Material exposures are known and controlled	Controls, incidents, testing and remediation
05	IP	Rights to code, data, models and dependencies are clear	Assignments, licences and component inventory
06	Team	Capability is durable beyond key individuals	Roles, tenure, knowledge and succession
07	Operations	Reliability, support and recovery meet needs	Service levels, telemetry, incidents and recovery
08	Economics	Technology cost and investment support the plan	Unit costs, commitments and required investment

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

Dimension	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Product and market	Fit, adoption, roadmap, differentiation and commitments	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Architecture and scalability	Design, constraints, performance, data and integration	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Engineering	Code health, testing, delivery, quality and technical debt	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Security and resilience	Governance, controls, incidents, availability and recovery	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	IP and third parties	Ownership, licences, open source, vendors and data rights	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Team and economics	Leadership, dependency, capacity, cost and required investment	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Product	Roadmap and customer value support the thesis	Adoption, retention, roadmap and differentiation
Architecture	The platform can scale and evolve	System design, constraints and transition needs
Code	Quality and delivery practices are sustainable	Repositories, testing, release and defect evidence
Security	Material exposures are known and controlled	Controls, incidents, testing and remediation
IP	Rights to code, data, models and dependencies are clear	Assignments, licences and component inventory
Team	Capability is durable beyond key individuals	Roles, tenure, knowledge and succession
Operations	Reliability, support and recovery meet needs	Service levels, telemetry, incidents and recovery
Economics	Technology cost and investment support the plan	Unit costs, commitments and required investment

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Evidence Room and Red Flag Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	Product strategy, roadmap and customer commitments are available and internally consistent.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Architecture diagrams show production systems, data, integrations and trust boundaries.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Repositories, build pipelines, testing, release and defect data can be reviewed securely.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Application, infrastructure, cloud and third-party inventories have accountable owners.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Security policies, testing, incidents, vulnerabilities and remediation evidence are indexed.	☐	☐	_____
A06	IP assignments, contractor terms, licences and open-source obligations are documented.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Service levels, capacity, incident, backup and recovery evidence is available.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Organization charts identify critical roles, vacancies, contractors and key-person dependencies.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Technology costs, commitments, capitalization and forecast assumptions reconcile to finance.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Management can explain known technical debt and the funded remediation roadmap.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Investment Thesis and Integration Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Revenue and growth assumptions are supported by product and platform evidence.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Scalability claims are supported by load, reliability and unit-cost data.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Customer-specific customizations and roadmap obligations are visible.	☐	☐	_____
B04	The target operating model identifies retained, changed and integrated capabilities.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Security and privacy gaps are classified by materiality and transaction consequence.	☐	☐	_____
B06	IP, data and model rights are sufficient for planned use and markets.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Critical vendors have acceptable contracts, continuity and replacement options.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Key employees and knowledge-transfer needs are reflected in transaction planning.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Remediation and integration estimates include cost, timing, dependency and execution risk.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Findings are separated into deal breakers, conditions, value adjustments and post-close actions.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Product and market	20%	Fit, adoption, roadmap, differentiation and commitments	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Architecture and scalability	20%	Design, constraints, performance, data and integration	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Engineering	15%	Code health, testing, delivery, quality and technical debt	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Security and resilience	15%	Governance, controls, incidents, availability and recovery	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
IP and third parties	15%	Ownership, licences, open source, vendors and data rights	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Team and economics	15%	Leadership, dependency, capacity, cost and required investment	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Sequence decisions, evidence and delivery so management can invest with confidence and stop weak initiatives early.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Mobilize	Confirm sponsor, scope, decision rights, evidence request and priority outcomes.	Approved mandate and fact base
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Review current evidence, interview owners, score readiness and identify hard gates.	Verified gaps and risk view
Days 36 to 55	Design	Define target operating, architecture, control and delivery options with economics.	Decision-ready options
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test assumptions with users, data, technology, vendors and accountable control owners.	Evidence-backed recommendation
Days 76 to 90	Authorize	Approve the roadmap, owners, funding, measures, next gate and stop conditions.	Executive investment decision

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish the fact base, governance and one bounded priority initiative.
- Quarter 2: prove value and control effectiveness in a production-relevant pilot.
- Quarters 3 and 4: scale reusable capabilities, operating ownership and benefits realization.
- Year 2: optimize economics, institutionalize governance and refresh the portfolio using measured results.

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology and commercialization advisor coordinating strategy, evidence, architecture, governance, partners and executive decisions. The objective is not to maximize activity. It is to direct management effort toward investments that are valuable, controllable and executable.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Establish the current fact base, hard gates, readiness score and management decisions.
Strategy and portfolio	Translate corporate priorities into a bounded, sequenced investment portfolio.
Architecture and data	Define target capabilities, integration, data, model, cloud and operating patterns.
Governance and risk	Design decision rights, policies, evidence, controls, monitoring and escalation.
Commercial and financial case	Model customer value, productivity, cost, funding, timing and benefits realization.
Vendor and partner ecosystem	Structure evaluation, sourcing, research, delivery and commercial relationships.
Execution readiness	Build roadmaps, work plans, budgets, measures, owners and decision gates.
Ongoing assurance	Monitor the portfolio, challenge evidence and bring decision-ready options to leadership.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive readiness diagnostic using this guide.
- Prioritized decision and evidence map with Pursue, Prepare and Monitor recommendations.
- One flagship initiative dossier with roadmap, economics, architecture and control plan.
- Executive readout and 90-day mobilization plan with accountable owners.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Demo bias	A polished interface masks structural weakness.	Test architecture, operations and delivery evidence.
Hidden debt	Growth requires unplanned platform investment.	Quantify debt by business consequence and remediation.
Security	Material exposure changes transaction risk.	Escalate incidents, control gaps and obligations early.
IP	Rights to code, data or models are incomplete.	Verify assignments, licences and provenance.
Key person	Critical knowledge is concentrated.	Assess dependency, retention and transfer.
Scale economics	Infrastructure cost rises faster than revenue.	Analyze unit cost, commitments and capacity.
Integration	Synergies require more change than assumed.	Map systems, data, identity and operating model dependencies.
Evidence quality	Management assertions cannot be substantiated.	Use traceable requests, sampling and confidence ratings.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

NIST Cybersecurity Framework 2.0. Official source — Outcome-based framework for governing and managing cybersecurity risk.
NIST Secure Software Development Framework 1.1. Official source — Secure-development practices for software producers and acquirers.
Canadian Centre for Cyber Security baseline controls. Official source — Canadian baseline cyber controls for small and medium organizations.
ISO IEC 42001 AI management systems. Official source — Management-system approach for responsible AI governance and continual improvement.
Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada AI guidance. Official source — Canadian privacy guidance for organizations developing or using AI.
Government of Canada Digital Standards. Official source — User-centred, secure, accessible and iterative digital-service principles.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.